

What's so interesting is the story the portfolio tells. It still has some of the same names it had in 1935: DuPont, General Electric, Proctor & Gamble and Union Pacific.

But it also has positions that came about through mergers and/or spinoffs. For example, it owns Berkshire Hathaway via an original position in the Atchison, Topeka and Santa Fe Railway. It has CBS via a stake in Westinghouse Electric. It owns Honeywell through a stake in Allied Chemical.

It has shares in Foot Locker because that's where a 1935 position in F.

W. Woolworth wound up. It owns ExxonMobil and Chevron, thanks to an investment in Rockefeller's Standard Oil.

There are only 21 names left, as some have gone on to the great big board in the sky, such as American Can and the Pennsylvania Railroad Co. Remarkably, the fund has beaten 98 percent of its peers over the last five- and ten-year periods. Wrote Kerber,

Over the five year period ended Feb. 24 [2015] the fund returned an average of 17.32 percent a year, including fees, 1.03 percentage point better than the S&P 500, said Morningstar. For the 10 years ended Feb. 24 the fund returned an average of 9.40 percent a year, including fees, 1.32 percentage point better than the S&P 500.

In fact, it's beaten the S&P 500 for 40 years. The fund's website doesn't go back any further than that, though I wonder what its performance has been like since inception.

It is a low-cost fund, with a fee of just 52 basis points, or 0.52 percent. (Most funds' fees are triple that.) And there are few capital gains taxes to pay, thanks to low turnover. (The fund still has to buy and sell to meet redemptions and invest new money.)

All in all, a remarkable little story about the power of sitting tight in a portfolio of carefully chosen stocks based on a sensible investment strategy.

The fund's original sponsor was Corporate Leaders of America. Today, after a series of deals, it's under Voya's umbrella. The original fund had a simple mandate, as described in a brochure on the fund's